

Informed Consent Form (ICF)

You are being invited to participate, as a volunteer, in an interview. After being informed about the details described below, if you agree to participate in the study, please sign this document at the end. This document is provided in two copies: one for you and one for the responsible researcher. If you refuse to participate, you will not be penalized in any way. If you have any questions, you may contact the responsible researchers:

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This academic research, entitled “**Addressing Ambiguity in Legal Requirements Engineering of Software Systems**,” aims to investigate how organizations deal with ambiguity present in legal texts during the specification of legal requirements in order to ensure compliance with legislation.

Among the expected benefits of the research is gaining a better understanding of the process used to address ambiguity in the specification of legal requirements during software development within the studied organization. Based on this understanding, the study aims to propose guidelines so that knowledge derived from organizational practices can be reused by other companies. These guidelines are intended to support requirements analysts in identifying ambiguity in both legal texts and requirements, and in specifying systems that comply with legislation.

Research participants will take part in an interview regarding the process of eliciting and specifying software requirements that must comply with specific legislation. The content of the interviews will **not influence the evaluation of employees’ job performance within the organization**.

The interview will be **audio recorded for documentation purposes**. If at any point during the interview the participant feels uncomfortable, they have the right to stop participating without any penalty.

Participants have the **right to be informed about the progress of the research**, even if the information provided is partial or preliminary.

Participants will **not incur any personal expenses** at any stage of the research. Likewise, there will be **no financial compensation or any other type of compensation** for participation.

This study does not involve physical risks. However, the topics discussed may potentially cause emotional discomfort, embarrassment, or unpleasant feelings when answering some questions. Therefore, as mentioned previously, participants may terminate the interview at any time if they wish.

Participation in this research is **voluntary and unpaid**. The participants’ working hours will be respected, and meetings will be scheduled according to their availability.

There is an unconditional guarantee that all collected data will be used **exclusively for scientific purposes**. The data and information obtained during this study may also be used in **future scientific publications or events**.

Participant Consent

I, _____,
the undersigned, agree to participate voluntarily in the **Exploratory Case Study on Ambiguity in Legal Requirements Specification**.

I have been properly informed and clarified by the researcher **Dorgival Pereira da Silva Netto** regarding the research, the procedures involved, and the possible risks and benefits resulting from my participation.

I have also been informed that I may refuse to participate in this research or withdraw my consent at any time, even after the study has begun, without providing justification and without any negative consequences for my relationship with the organization.

I am aware that my privacy will be respected, meaning that any information or element that may identify me will be kept confidential.

Having been fully informed about the content described above and having understood the nature and objectives of this study, I freely consent to participate, fully aware that there is **no financial or material compensation to receive or to pay** for my participation.

Location and date: _____

Participant Name and Signature

Dorgival Pereira da Silva Netto
Interviewer